

LINGXIAO CHEN

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EDUCATION

Emory University	Atlanta, GA
Ph.D. in Sociology	2022–2027 (Expected)
- Research interests: political sociology, cultural sociology, nationalism, public opinion - Dissertation: <i>Nationalizing Stardom: Making and Judging Celebrity Politics in China</i>	
University of Hong Kong	Pokfulam, HK
B.A. (First Class Honors), Sociology & Translation, with a minor in French	2021

PUBLICATIONS

Chen, Lingxiao. 2026. "Performing Nationalism: Celebrity Politics and Audience Boundary Work under Authoritarianism." *American Sociological Review*, 91(3), 405-434.

- Winner of the ASA Sociology of Culture Section Richard A. Peterson Award for Best Student Paper (2026)
- Runner-up of the ASA Social Psychology Section Graduate Student Paper Award (2026)
- Winner of the ASA Asia and Asian American Section Graduate Student Paper Award (2026)

Xu, Bin, **Lingxiao Chen**, and Xueqia Zhang. 2025. "How to Say 'Black Lives Matter' in Chinese?: Race, Democracy, and Discourses of a Movement." *Social Problems*, 73(2), 718-734.

WORKING PAPERS

"Nationalist Signaling as Image Repair: Celebrity Transgression and Moral Evaluation in China." Draft available.

"Moral Hierarchy and Market Discipline: The Engineering of Entertainers in China." Book chapter, *The Politics of Moral Engineering in China* (Edited Volume). Draft available.

"The Permissible Feminist: How Authoritarian Institutions Shape Feminist Consciousness From Within." (With Zepeng Zhou).

AWARDS, HONORS, & SCHOLARSHIPS

Richard A. Peterson Award for Best Student Paper, ASA Culture Section	2026
Awarded to the best paper on cultural sociology by a graduate student	
ASA Social Psychology Section Graduate Student Paper Award (Honorable Mention)	2026
Awarded to the best paper on social psychology by a graduate student	
ASA Asia & Asian America Section Graduate Student Paper Award \$300	2026
Awarded to the best grad paper on Asia/Transnational or Asian America published in 2024 and 2025	
ASA Student Forum Travel Awards \$400	2026
Award supporting ASA Student Members to attend the annual meeting	
People's Choice Award, Three Minute Thesis Competition \$250	2026
Top-voted presenter among university-wide 3MT finalists at Emory University	

Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies \$3,000 Research grants for the project <i>Celebrity-Mediated Nationalism</i>	2025
OYCF-Chow Field Research Fellow, Overseas Young Chinese Forum \$5,000 Award supporting dissertation fieldwork in China Studies (5 recipients annually in North America)	2025
Maureen Blyler Graduate Research Award, Emory Sociology \$250 Awarded for the best research paper by an Emory Sociology graduate student	2025
Graduate Global Research Fellow, The Halle Institute for Global Research \$5,000 Fellowship supporting pre-candidacy fieldwork for the project <i>Celebrity-Mediated Nationalism</i>	2024
Professional Development Support Funds, Laney Graduate School \$2,500 Conference travel grant and training grant for attending the ICPSR quantitative training	2023
Martin L. Levin Scholarship for Summer ICPSR Training \$2,500 Fellowship awarded annually to support one Emory Sociology student in advanced quantitative training	2023
Rosita King Ho Scholarship \$37,340 Entrance scholarship covering half the tuition fees at HKU	2017 – 2021
Talent Development Scholarship under the HKSAR Gov Scholarship Fund \$1,300 National Champion, National Creative English Competition of China	2020
Reaching Out Award under the HKSAR Gov Scholarship Fund \$1,300 Scholarship for participation in overseas exchange programs	2020
Pembroke-King's Programme - HKU Scholarship \$9,450 Fully funded summer program at the University of Cambridge (up to three awards granted annually)	2019
The Consular Book Award in American Studies, U.S. Consulate General HK \$200 Scholarship for outstanding academic performance in American Studies at HKU	2018
Dean's Honours List, University of Hong Kong Honorary Awarded for outstanding academic achievements at HKU	2017-2021
National Champion, National Creative English Contest of China Honorary First place among 70,000 high school student contestants nationwide	2016

TEACHING

Emory University

- Political Sociology (Instructor, scheduled Spring 2027)
- Qualitative Research Methods (TA, Graduate/PhD course, Fall 2024)
- Teaching Sociology (Pedagogy training, Spring 2024)
- Development of Sociological Theory (TA, Undergraduate course, Fall 2023)
- Culture and Society (TA, Undergraduate, Fall 2022)

Guest Lectures

- "Black Lives Matter Discourse in China," SOC 346, Colby College (Mar 2025)
- "Entertainment and Politics," SOC 334, Emory University (Apr 2024)
- "Black Lives Matter Discourse in China," Asian America Series, University of Pennsylvania (Nov 2023)

PRESENTATIONS

Performing Nationalism: Celebrity Politics and Audience Boundary Work

- Overseas Young China Scholars Annual Meeting (Aug 2025)
- Ethnography and Qualitative Research International Conference, University of Trento (July 2025)
- Security and Conflict Lab, Department of Political Science, Emory University (April 2025)
- American Sociological Association: Nationalist Discourse and Lived Realities Panel (Aug 2024)
- Young Scholars Conference, UC San Diego (May 2024)

From Revolution to Regulation: Moral Engineering of China's Entertainment

- The Politics of Moral Engineering in China Workshop, University of Vienna (July 2025)

How to Say "Black Lives Matter" in Chinese?: Race, Democracy, and Discourses of a Movement

- Global Black Lives Matter: An Online Symposium (Sep 2023)
- American Sociological Association: Section on Sociology of Culture (Aug 2023)

SERVICE

To the Discipline

- **Reviewer**
American Sociological Review
- **Presider** 2026
ASA Sociology of Culture Section, ASA Political Sociology Section
- **Section Committee** 2025
Members of AMSS Outstanding Graduate Student Paper Award Committee
Member of Social Psychology Nominations Committee

To Emory University

- Social Chair, Coalition of Graduate Students, Department of Sociology 2022–2025
- Mentor, Sociology Research Apprenticeship (SRA) Program 2024
- Panelist, "Teaching as an International TA," International Student and Scholar Services 2024

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

ICPSR Summer Program	Ann Arbor, MI
Summer Courses, Text Analysis and Causal Inference	2023
University of California, Santa Barbara	Santa Barbara, CA
Semester Exchange, Sociology (Dean's Honor, GPA: 3.92/4)	2020
University of Cambridge	Cambridge, UK
Pembroke-King's Programme (Full Scholarship), Independent Research, Economic Sociology	2019

SKILLS

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), Cantonese (fluent), French (intermediate)

Tools: R, Python, L^AT_EX, MAXQDA, Qualtrics

REFERENCES

Timothy J. Dowd

Department of Sociology, Emory University
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Weihua An

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Renard Sexton

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